

credit card debt. I had no debt at all. All I had was savings. And I kept saving throughout my 40s so that I could treat myself to a little luxury in a few years ... but I had to earn it first.

THE 50s

If you did what you were supposed to in your 30s and 40s, you've won yourself a little breathing room. By now, you've paid down your debt and saved up a lot of money; your career is going well. You can afford to reward yourself. For me, that reward took the shape of a Porsche; consider what's appropriate for you. Channel all your midlife angst into this luxury purchase. Just remember: *you cannot splurge unless you have a really good nest egg*. If you've got one, great. Get yourself a little gift. You deserve it.

THE 60s

In your 60s, you are rehearsing for retirement. You should know your 90-Day Number inside out and know how to strike a balance between what you invest and what you spend. Live within your means, and do not deplete your principal. You don't know how long you're going to live, so spend like you'll live to be 100. By now, you should be a fine-tuned financial machine.